Manager Tell-All Interview

Park: _____ **Manager:** _____ **Date:** _____

Do this during diligence, with the seller's permission. The manager runs the park day to day and knows what the brochure leaves out. Promise nothing about their job.

1. Setup

Ask on site or by phone, with the seller's okay. Say up front you cannot promise anything about their job. You want to understand how the park really runs.

2. Collections reality

1. "Who pays late most often, and how far behind do they get?"
2. "How many tenants are 30 or more days behind right now?"
3. "How many evictions did you do last year?"
4. "Do tenants ever pay in cash? Who handles that money?"
5. "When someone stops paying, what actually happens? Walk me through it."

3. Tenants

6. "Are there any tenants you'd warn a new owner about?"
7. "Any drug activity or police visits I should know about?"
8. "How many of your tenants are long-timers versus people passing through?"
9. "Which lots have the most turnover, and why?"

4. Maintenance backlog

10. "What's broken right now that hasn't been fixed?"
11. "What breaks every winter without fail?"
12. "What does the owner keep patching instead of replacing?"
13. "When a home gets abandoned, what do you do with it?"
14. "How old are the water heaters and furnaces in the park-owned homes?"
15. "If you had $20,000 to spend on this park, where would it go first?"

5. Infrastructure trouble spots

16. "Where does the sewer back up, and how often?"
17. "Any lots with low water pressure, or water that runs brown?"
18. "Any electrical pedestals that trip, spark, or look burnt?"
19. "How are the roads after a hard rain? Any lots that flood?"
20. "When was the last time the septic or sewer system had real work done?"

6. Evasive-answer signals

- "Everyone pays on time." Nobody tracked it. Ask to see the late list or the ledger.
- "The owner handles that." The manager was cut out. Ask the owner, and ask why.
- Laughter before answering. There is a story they do not want to tell. Wait, then ask once more, gently.